



Photograph Mexy Xavier

Beat That!

Digit Caption Sachin! How's the elbow?

Every month, *Digit* will carry a funny caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat them at their own game!

Last Month's Winner!

Unfortunately, no one could send in a caption witty enough to be adjudged winner. Better luck this time!

Send your captions to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win a book.

Computer Systems

A Programmer's Perspective

By Randal E

Bryant and

David O'

Hallaron

Published by

Pearson

Education



is the low cost; Microsoft hopes to cut down on rampant piracy of its operating systems. Sources suggest the price will be in the vicinity of Rs 2,000.

Starter Edition will be light on features and is aimed solely at entry-level systems from computer makers Acer, Hewlett-Packard, HCL and Wipro.



The variant will not compete with its higher priced brethren—the ability to do home networking has been cut off. So has the feature that allows more than one user to use a single PC. Additionally, the OS will only allow a maximum screen resolution of 800 x 600. Most importantly, a user will be limited to multi-

tasking solely between three open windows or foreground applications.

When it comes to regional languages, the Starter Edition will initially only support Hindi; the company says it might add additional languages in the future. It will also sport some seemingly inane “features” such as localised wallpapers and screensavers (perhaps the rolling green of a default XP installation will be replaced by a picture of the Taj Mahal?)

Windows XP Starter Edition seems like a sweet deal to OEMs, so that they are not tempted to look to Linux for cheaper solutions. Microsoft is apparently content with targeting first-time users of computers instead of offering genuinely low-cost and feature-rich solutions to a price-sensitive market. The effectiveness of the Starter Edition to curb piracy remains to be seen—how soon will a user switch to a “cheaper” and fully-featured Windows XP?

As soon as his or her friend hands over a copy, we imagine.

REAL-WORLD APPLICATIONS CONTEST

ZDNet India Developer Challenge

ZDNet India (www.zdnetindia.com), India's leading technology portal, has announced the country's first ever Linux and Web Services developer contests

on the IBM Platform. The contest is open to both teams and individual developers.

The ZDNet India Developer Challenge comprises two different contests—a Linux Development Contest and a Web Services Development Contest for Windows. A panel of judges from the Industry will evaluate entries based on functionality, elegance and other factors. The first three entries in each category will be awarded an IBM ThinkCentre

Best Buys



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